

Detailed user journey: primary user = program owner / HR or internal communications lead

1. A need emerges

The user starts because they need to orchestrate a high-stakes employee experience — for example onboarding, training, or engagement — and doing it manually is slow, inconsistent, and hard to scale. Their goal is not just to “make a journey,” but to create a coordinated experience that reaches the right people at the right time with the right logic behind it. Journeys exists because organizations need a more scalable way to manage those experiences while reducing manual effort.

What the user is thinking:

“What experience am I trying to create, and how do I launch it without building everything from scratch every time?”

What they need most here:

Confidence that the system can support the outcome they want.

2. Enter the builder

The user enters the Journeys builder and has to choose how to begin. This is the first major fork in the journey: do they start from a reusable template, or do they build from scratch? In your materials, reusable templates became important because they reduced upfront effort and gave users a faster starting point, which later became foundational to Journeys AI.

User actions:

Choose a template or blank journey, name the journey, select a use case, orient themselves to the structure.

Core user need:

Orientation. They need to understand where they are, what kind of object they’re creating, and how much work lies ahead.

Primary risk:

If the builder feels too open-ended too early, users feel cognitive overload before they have any momentum.

3. Define the audience and trigger conditions

Once inside, the user has to define **who** should enter the journey and **when** they should enter it. This is where logic begins to matter:

employee groups, lifecycle triggers, segments, timing, or eligibility rules. Your case-study materials repeatedly point to this setup/configuration phase as the place where users stalled.

User actions:

Select audience segments, set conditions, define entry triggers, choose timing rules.

Core user need:

Guidance. Users need help understanding which decisions are required now versus later.

Primary risk:

Too many choices too early makes the experience feel heavy and brittle. Users may hesitate because they are unsure whether they are configuring the journey correctly.

4. Build the journey structure

Now the user starts shaping the journey itself: steps, messages, content, branches, and sequencing. This is the "construction" phase where the user's mental model and the system model need to stay aligned. Your materials describe this as a complex orchestration workflow involving triggers, actions, and conditions, and note that your work focused on simplifying those multi-step flows.

User actions:

Add steps, sequence communications, choose content, configure logic, define dependencies.

Core user need:

Clarity plus momentum. They need to feel like each action moves the journey meaningfully forward.

Primary risk:

The user can lose track of:

- what is already complete
- what is required
- what is optional
- what will happen next

This is where the product has to answer three questions quickly:

Where am I? What matters now? What do I need to do next? That exact sequencing lens shows up in your case-study framing.

5. Validate the setup

As the workflow becomes more complex, the user needs the system to

tell them what is broken, incomplete, or risky. In your Journeys materials, you describe designing systems that could identify stalled workflows, surface errors, and help users take action quickly rather than feel blocked.

User actions:

Review validation states, fix missing fields, resolve logic issues, correct content or targeting mistakes.

Core user need:

Supportive error handling. The user needs actionable feedback, not just warnings.

Primary risk:

If errors are vague or hidden, users lose trust in the system and hesitate to launch. This is where confidence can collapse even if the UI looks clean.

6. Review and prepare to launch

At this point, the user is close to launch, but this is often where anxiety spikes. They are not just asking, "Can I publish?" They are asking, "Am I sure this will work?" Your framing around the **downstream trust effect** is especially relevant here: design does not just improve speed; it determines whether the user feels confident enough to keep moving.

User actions:

Review the journey holistically, sanity-check audience logic, confirm steps, scan for missing pieces, prepare to launch.

Core user need:

Confidence through visibility. Users need to see the journey clearly enough to trust it.

Primary risk:

The builder may be technically complete, but the user may still not feel psychologically ready to launch if the experience does not communicate confidence.

7. Launch

The user launches the journey. This is the visible moment of success in the workflow, but it is not the end of the journey — it is the start of the management phase. Your materials make clear that Journeys is not only about creation; it also includes a complementary interface for managing, tracking, and adjusting what was launched.

User actions:

Publish or activate the journey.

Core user need:

Clear confirmation that the launch succeeded and what happens next.

Primary risk:

If post-launch visibility is weak, users may feel like the system "disappears" after activation.

8. Monitor progress in the management interface

After launch, the user shifts from builder mode into management mode.

This is the second major half of the product experience. Your notes explicitly describe the management interface as allowing users to **see progress, diagnose where and why users stalled, track engagement metrics, identify errors, and resolve issues proactively.**

User actions:

Track journey status, review progression, look for stalled points, inspect performance, monitor health.

Core user need:

Transparency. Users need to know whether the journey is actually working.

Primary risk:

If the user cannot quickly understand what is happening, the product fails at the exact moment they are looking for proof of value.

9. Diagnose issues and intervene

If something is underperforming, the user needs to identify what went wrong and adjust the journey. This is where a management interface becomes more than reporting — it becomes an operational tool. Your materials describe this as a system for helping users **identify where people stalled, resolve workflow issues, and take action.**

User actions:

Inspect stalled steps, review errors or drop-off points, make updates, reconfigure parts of the journey, refine content or logic.

Core user need:

Actionability. Users need insights they can do something with.

Primary risk:

If reporting is passive rather than actionable, the user sees data but cannot improve the experience.

10. Learn, iterate, and scale

Once the user has launched and learned from the journey, the next job is not to rebuild from zero — it is to make the workflow easier to repeat. This is why templates became strategically important in your story: they reduce activation burden, improve speed, and support repeatable adoption over time. Your resume and portfolio materials also tie this directly to outcomes: **40% improvement in user task efficiency, 20% reduction in setup time**, and later **50% adoption in the first quarter** for the template-led Journeys AI direction.

User actions:

Reuse what worked, templatize the setup, standardize best practices, scale the workflow across more use cases.

Core user need:

Efficiency at scale. The user wants the next journey to be easier than the first.

Primary risk:

If every new journey still feels like a full rebuild, the product may be usable but it is not truly scalable.

Emotional journey

This is the emotional arc I'd use if you want the journey to feel more human in your case study:

Need / urgency → overwhelm → cautious progress → uncertainty → confidence → visibility → control → repeatability

That arc matches your broader narrative:

- users entered the flow with a goal
- got stalled by burden and ambiguity
- needed more than visual clarity
- responded better when the product gave stronger guidance and lower-effort entry points
- ultimately gained confidence to launch and iterate over time

Simplified journey for a slide / animated graphic

If you want the cleanest version for a single visual:

Need identified → Enter builder → Choose starting point → Define audience and triggers → Configure journey steps → Validate setup → Launch → Monitor progress → Diagnose issues → Iterate and templatize

And the **critical friction moments** to highlight are:

- **starting from nothing**

- **high-effort configuration**
- **unclear validation**
- **confidence before launch**
- **understanding what happened after launch**